

LYONIAN DAILY

IN MEMORY

28TH JULY 1914 - 11TH NOVEMBER 1918

CENTENARY EDITION

4TH AUGUST ~ BRITAIN JOINS THE WAR

THE 59 LYONIANS



Eric Stearns

An introduction from Mr C. Longhurst & Mr J. Moore

The 59 Club is The John Lyon School's latest History society for boys in Years 9 and 10, but also some gifted Year 8 students. It was established in November 2013 in response to the forthcoming First World War centenary commemorations: 59 being the number of John Lyon pupils who fought and died in the conflict between 1914 and 1918. Subsequent research has shown this number to actually be 61 (60 pupils and 1 teacher), but we have decided to keep the original name.

Members of *The 59 Club* have been very busy on Friday lunch times using the computers to research the lives and deaths of these men and as a mark of respect, have created this impressive piece of work. The History Department would like to take this opportunity to thank the boys for their hard work over the last year and commitment to this considerable task and for creating such a fantastic commemorative overview of these men's lives - 'The 59 Club: The Fallen'.

This piece of work contains information about 44 of the 61 men. The level of detail varies considerably due to the amount of information that is available from a whole host of websites that the boys have explored, as well as letters from the trenches that have been read carefully. Within this piece of work there are some truly compelling and moving stories of loss and sacrifice. Unfortunately, for three of the Lyonians, all that could be found was a date of death, highlighting the chaotic nature of the First World War and the records kept.

In future years, *The 59 Club* will commemorate the anniversary of an event of the pupils' choosing. The Year 11 boys will graduate to *The 59 Upper Club* where historical themes will be discussed with Sixth Form pupils and History teachers.

Next year's commemorative event will be the 70th anniversary of the conclusion of the Second World War. *The 59 Club* will be researching the lives of the Old Lyonians that fell in that conflict. Coincidentally, and rather eerily, 60 Old Lyonians and 1 member of staff died in that conflict as well, according to current records. Will the new *59 Club* detect additional pupils or teachers who gave their lives?

THE FIRST & LAST

THE FIRST

Reid, L T S

It is believed that L T S Reid died on the penultimate day of the Battle of Messines from 12th October to 2nd November 1914. He was a school captain and a former editor of the *Lyonian Magazine*. He was the first Lyonian to fall. He scored 100 for the school cricket team in 1913 and was awarded a pewter tankard for it. Despite this he was not viewed as an amazing batsman and was criticised because of this. He was in the London Scottish and was aged just 17 when he fell.

THE LAST

Woodbridge, S

Captain Stanley Woodbridge, Military Cross, was the last Lyonian to perish as a result of World War One. His death is recorded as 18th December 1918, although he was severely wounded earlier in the year. The way he died perhaps reflects the horrific nature of the conflict. He is first reported as injured by the Lyonian late in 1918. It states: "We are very grieved to hear that Captain Stanley Woodbridge M.C. was so terribly wounded. After lying for six hours on the battle field, bleeding well nigh to death, he was taken back to the hospital, where amputation of the leg was imperative. He is still too exhausted to write or receive visitors; but he was able to dictate a letter, for which we were grateful" (sadly the letter appears lost). He was one of 10 Lyonians to be awarded the Military Cross for his bravery on the front line, and the only one of those ten who made the ultimate sacrifice.

A later edition then reported that he had "died from his wounds" due to the fact that his "leg was shattered by a shell, and he lay on the field bleeding to death. Although brought home to England, he was too weak to recover." It went on to describe him as a "splendid young fellow, and before the war he led the Old Lyonian Football Teams to a long series of victories." The *Lyonian* has frequent mention of him as a talented sportsman and strong participant with the Old Boys teams.

He is buried and remembered at Harrow St Mary's Lower Churchyard.

RESEARCHERS AND CONTRIBUTORS

Year 11: Amar Bisal □ James Boyle □ Alexander Clarke □ Benjamin Kelly □ Jack McCabe □ Neisewand Hussain

Year 10: Anthony Close □ Cameron Sanghera □ Rahul Sindwani

Year 9: Javier D'Souza □ Jude Hedges-Robinson □ Matthew McClymont □ Imad Rajput □ Asher Weisz

WAR'S HISTORY

THE CAUSE OF WORLD WAR ONE

Prior to the war, Europe was in a state of considerable tension, with issues based on colonialism, nationalism, expansionism, and military and economic competition between countries. Europe was divided into two main alliances: the Triple Alliance (Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy) and the Triple Entente (The United Kingdom, France and the Russian Empire). The developing events and crises between these European powers, such as influence over the Balkans – between Austria-Hungary and Russia, the dispute between Alsace Lorraine – between France and Germany and the arms and naval race between all the European powers (specifically Britain and Germany) as well as the economic supremacy race between Germany and Britain caused mass tension and unease.

However, the war was triggered by the assassination of the Austro-Hungarian Archduke Franz Ferdinand in the Bosnian capital of Sarajevo, by the Serbian nationalist Gavrilo Princip, who was part of a secret military society, which longed for the unification of Slavic countries in the Balkans with Serbia to form 'Yugoslavia.' This sparked the July Crisis of 1914, where Austria-Hungary demanded compensation for their King's death and military support from Serbia to find the 'assassins' who killed the Austrian king. This was delivered as an ultimatum, which was quickly denied by Serbia.

This culminated in Austria-Hungary declaring war on Serbia and quickly invading the nation. This prompted Russia to declare war on Austria-Hungary, causing a domino effect of declarations of war throughout Europe. The only nation to not declare war immediately was the United Kingdom. However, when Germany's Schlieffen Plan came in to effect and Belgium was invaded, the UK declared war on Germany. Despite Britain's great industrial and naval might, her army was fewer than 1 million, compared to the French army (4 million men) the Russian army (6 million men) and Germany and Austria-Hungary's respective 4.5 million and 3 million men armies. This caused Britain to mobilise its population and conscripted millions of men and boys into the British army, 61 of whom fought and died from The John Lyon School.

A SNAPSHOT OF SCHOOL LIFE

CRICKET NEWS

1ST XI. v. PARENTS.

It was very unfortunate that the second evening for the Parents' Match should be spoiled by the rain. However, more's the pity, as the first night's play was very enjoyable. The Parents had first knock, but only scored 37, out of which Mr. Kindler made 12. The Parents' bowling did not trouble the School much, and 80 runs were scored for the loss of 1 wicket. Massey made 40 not out, Kinsey 21, and Dawson 19, not out.

1st XI v WATFORD GRAMMAR SCHOOL

The first match of the season was played at Watford on Saturday, May 4th, when the School XI. played Watford Grammar School 1st XI. Our opponents batted first and were dismissed when they had knocked up 99 runs. The School then went in and made a very poor show, managing to obtain only 28 runs. Johnson for the team took SIX wickets for 40 runs and King played a good all round game. The School 2nd XI lost by two runs against Watford Grammar School 2nd XI. Lee in this match bowled exceedingly well, taking eight wickets for nine runs. Nullmeyer also did well.

1ST XI. v. AMERSHAM GRAMMAR SCHOOL

On May 19th, the School were visited by Amersham Grammar School. The visitors batted first. The Amersham side collapsed utterly, and were skittled out for 17 runs. Mellor took 4 wickets for 5 runs, and Massey 6 for 11. The School in their turn did not give a great batting display on account of the slow pitch, but the following batted creditably Bates, 16; Massey, 15; Dawson, 15; and Matthews, 14. The School made 71, thus winning by 54 runs.

FOOTBALL NEWS

1ST XI. v. HARROW COUNTY SCHOOL.

Result: School, 8; H.C.S., 2.

The third local "Derby" of the season took place on March 27th, on the opponents' ground. The scores in the three matches were: 8-1, 5-1, and 8-2, all in favour of the School. As in the other two matches the conditions were very bad. There was a fall of snow just before the game started, but it stopped for the kick-off. The County School led off with a terrific rush, and set a pace they could not and did not keep up for more than five minutes. After about five minutes' play the County School scored with a goal that was generally thought to be offside. The snow came on again after this, but it did not prevent Massey getting the equalising goal. Just about this period several fouls were missed, against the School, on account of the palpable weakness of the referee. For the rest of the first half the County School were not in it, and Massey and MacKay added goals. Soon after the interval the County School were awarded a decidedly off-side goal, and from thence onwards a regular rough and tumble ensued, in which the School certainly did not come off the winner. Before concluding, Massey and Mellor scored two goals each and Woodbridge one.

1ST XI. v. PINNER COMMERCIAL TRAVELLERS SCHOOL.

Result: School, 8; C.T.S., 0.

This game was played at home on March 24th. The School played a winning game from the start, and the first goal came from Mellor after a few minutes' play. This was followed almost immediately by another from MacKay. Mellor and Massey obtained two more goals before the interval. In the second half the School monopolised the play even more than in the first half, and before the final whistle went the School were leading by 8 goals to nil. The goals were scored by-Massey, 4; Mellor, 3; MacKay, 1.

2ND XI. v. VICTORIA HALL 1ST XI.

Result: School won by 7 goals to 2.

On October 3rd the School 2nd XI. played the Victoria Hall School 1st XI on the Harrow Recreation Ground. In the first half the School netted the ball three times, the visitors failing to score. In the second half the School played up-hill, but for all that the School made their score up to 7 goals. For the School Haines scored two, while the remaining goals were scored by MacKay, Coyne, Gregg, Lee and Trace.

2ND XI. v. CALEDONIAN SCHOOL 1ST XI.

Result: School 6 goals, Caledonian School 1 goal.

The above match was played on the ground of the Caledonian School, at Bushey, on Saturday 27th October, the afternoon being an ideal one for the game. From the commencement, we had the better of our opponents and after about five minutes play Harold opened our score by a well-placed shot. Later Fitzsimons and Murray scored. Thus at half time the score stood at 3-0 in favour of the School. In the second half Fitzsimons broke through our opponents' defence and scored. A little later by judicious play on the part of the Caledonians a well-deserved goal was scored by the centre forward. Two more goals were added by the Lyons a few minutes after, Murray and Lee scoring. When the whistle blew for time the score stood at 6-1 in our favour. Thanks are due to the Headmaster for kindly entertaining the eleven to tea.

THE FALLEN

"WHAT IS PATRIOTISM? IT IS THE SACRIFICING OF YOURSELF FOR YOUR COUNTRY, OR THE COMMUNITY OF WHICH YOU ARE A MEMBER. PATRIOTISM IS ONE OF THE MOST NOBLE OF IMPULSES, FOR IT ENTAILS A SACRIFICING OF SELF.... THE TRUE PATRIOT IS THE MAN WHO GIVES UP HIMSELF AND EVERYTHING HE HAS FOR HIS COUNTRY."

Abbati, W R



William 'Bill' Abbati served as a second lieutenant of the Essex Regiment. He was born in Croydon in 1896 and died at the age of 21 on 9th August 1916. He was posthumously awarded the Victory and British War Medals. He did not appear to have fought in a battle; however, he died in Felixstowe while serving with the 3rd Battalion.

Lieutenant William Abbati (3rd Essex Regiment) died after a severe illness following constant exposure during training. He was at Osborne House, but he was not able to recover.

Asher, K J P

Kenneth John Penrith Asher was the son of George Willis Penrith Asher and Esther Fallon and was born in Algiers in 1887 and moved to England when he was young. His sisters were called Cecile and Geraldine; his great grandfather invented one of the first refrigerators. While he lived in Harrow, Kenneth and his family lived on 25 Hinds Road and while at John Lyon he became house captain; and at the age of 17 he left the School to join the Kings Own Yorkshire Light Infantry. He rose quickly to the rank of second lieutenant in the 10th battalion before being struck down in the first hour of the first day of the Somme offensive at the Battle of Loos. He is now buried at Norfolk Cemetery, NR Becaudel, Chateau Becourt, Northern France.

Ashford, R E C

Reginald Edwin Cecil Ashford born in Parsons Green 1894 was the son of Edwin Charles and Mabel Elizabeth Ashford lived on 37, Salisbury Rd., Harrow-on-the-Hill, Middlesex. Ashford was a lance corporal of the 1st/28th Bn. London Regiment (Artists' Rifles) who fought and served in France and Flanders but was killed in action on 30th October 1917 aged 23, on the fourth day of the Second Battle of Passchendaele. He is remembered with Honour at the Tyne Cot Memorial.

Bates, A J E

Born in 1894, Chorleywood, to Arthur Joseph Bates and Jesse Ann Bates. Arthur James Edmund Bates died 30th July 1917 from wounds aged 23 and buried in Christ Church, Chorleywood.

From October 1916 the Royal Engineers had been working underground, constructing tunnels for the troops in preparation for the Battle of Arras in 1917. Beneath Arras itself there is a vast network of caverns called the boves, consisting of underground quarries and sewage tunnels. The engineers came up with a plan to add new tunnels to this network so that troops could arrive at the battlefield in secrecy and in safety. The size of the excavation was immense. In one sector alone four Tunnel Companies of 500 men each worked around the clock in 18-hour shifts for two months.

Given the information we have available it is likely that Arthur James Edmund Bates was entitled to the Victory Medal, also called the Inter Allied Victory Medal. This medal was awarded to all who received the 1914 Star or 1914-15 Star and, with certain exceptions, to those who received the British War Medal. It was never awarded alone. These three medals were sometimes irreverently referred to as Pip, Squeak and Wilfred.

Eligibility for this award consisted of having been mobilised, fighting, having served in any of the theatres of operations, or at sea, between midnight 4th/5th August, 1914, and midnight, 11th/12th November, 1918. Women who served in any of the various military organisations in a theatre of operations were also eligible.

From the information available to us, it is very possible that Arthur James Edmund Bates was entitled to the British War Medal for service in World War One. This British Empire campaign medal was issued for services between 5th August 1914 and 11th November 1918.

The medal was automatically awarded in the event of death on active service before the completion of this period.

Beatty, A H W

Early Life

Arthur Harry Wolesly Beatty was born in 1888 and was baptised in the same year in St. James Park in London. He was the son of Joseph Bentley Higginson Beatty and Isabella Marcia Beatty who lived at 24 Gayton Road, Harrow-on-the-Hill. Arthur never married before his death at the age of 29.



War

At some point during the war he joined the Manchester Regiment (we are unsure whether or not this was due to conscription) and rose to the rank of 2nd lieutenant. He was killed in action on 31st July 1917. He died on the first day of the battle of Pilckem Ridge, part of the Third Battle of Ypres

Berry, H H

Hedley Herbert Berry was a lieutenant, unit of The Buffs, the Royal Naval Air Service who died on 27 September 1918 flying near Coventry. He was a very talented sportsman.



Best, J

Rank: Captain
Regiment: Machine Gun Corps, 34th Company.
DOD: 15/05/1918
Armentieres aged 26.
Remembered- Contay British cemetery.
Other Note: This regiment was the first to use tanks. Lived in Bank house, Midhurst, Sussex.

Biography – The second son of Mr and Mrs A. M. Best. He only stayed for the Lower school at John Lyon then moving to Church's Collage, Petersfield. He then began work at the London and County bank. He was also known at Horsham, Uckfield and Worthing for his business but also for his athletics. He enlisted in the Hants R.G.A. and then after three months was sent to the Royal Sussex Regiment. In 1915 he was transferred to the M.G.C. and proceeded to the front in March 1916. That was where he died on 15th May 1918. He managed to survive all of the Somme in the 91st company and he served with them until 1917 when he was second in command. In October he was promoted to Captain. He emerged with barely a wound on him from the battles around Armentières but was hit with some shrapnel from a shell in the morning of May 15th. He had only been with that company for a few short weeks but his senior officer quotes "In the Short time we had grown to be friends, I had always found him to be a soldier and a gentleman". His last leave was in November 1917 and he was going to go home a mere six days after he was killed. His brother tried to see him in the machine gun corps and had met with him in England but they only spent two hours together in three years apart. His elder brother A.F. Best was wounded five times and was awarded his M.C. in the Birthday Honours List, whilst his younger brother E. Best served in France, Palestine and India in the Indian Regular Army.

NEW DISCOVERIES

During the course of our research we discovered that there may have been other Lyonians killed in the war. For some reason they were not recorded or were lost to time. One was a former teacher, Wiseman, who we assume was not recorded as he was not a boy but staff. He was killed after both his legs were shot. Secondly we found a boy, King, who was in finance before the war. He was respected by his men and we do not know why he was omitted from the records. These boys have a special place in 59 history as they were never known before we discovered them.

King, F B

He was born in Northwood and was a prefect in the school in 1907. Prior to the war he worked in the finance department of Middlesex County Council. In 1914 he signed up to join the Queen's Westminsters and reached the rank of sergeant. He was killed on 8th December 1917 whilst fighting in Palestine.

Wiseman, H C

Rifleman H. C. Wiseman was seriously wounded in both legs on May 3rd 1917 in the Boulogne area of Franc. One of his legs was amputated but sadly he died from his wounds on May 19th 1917.

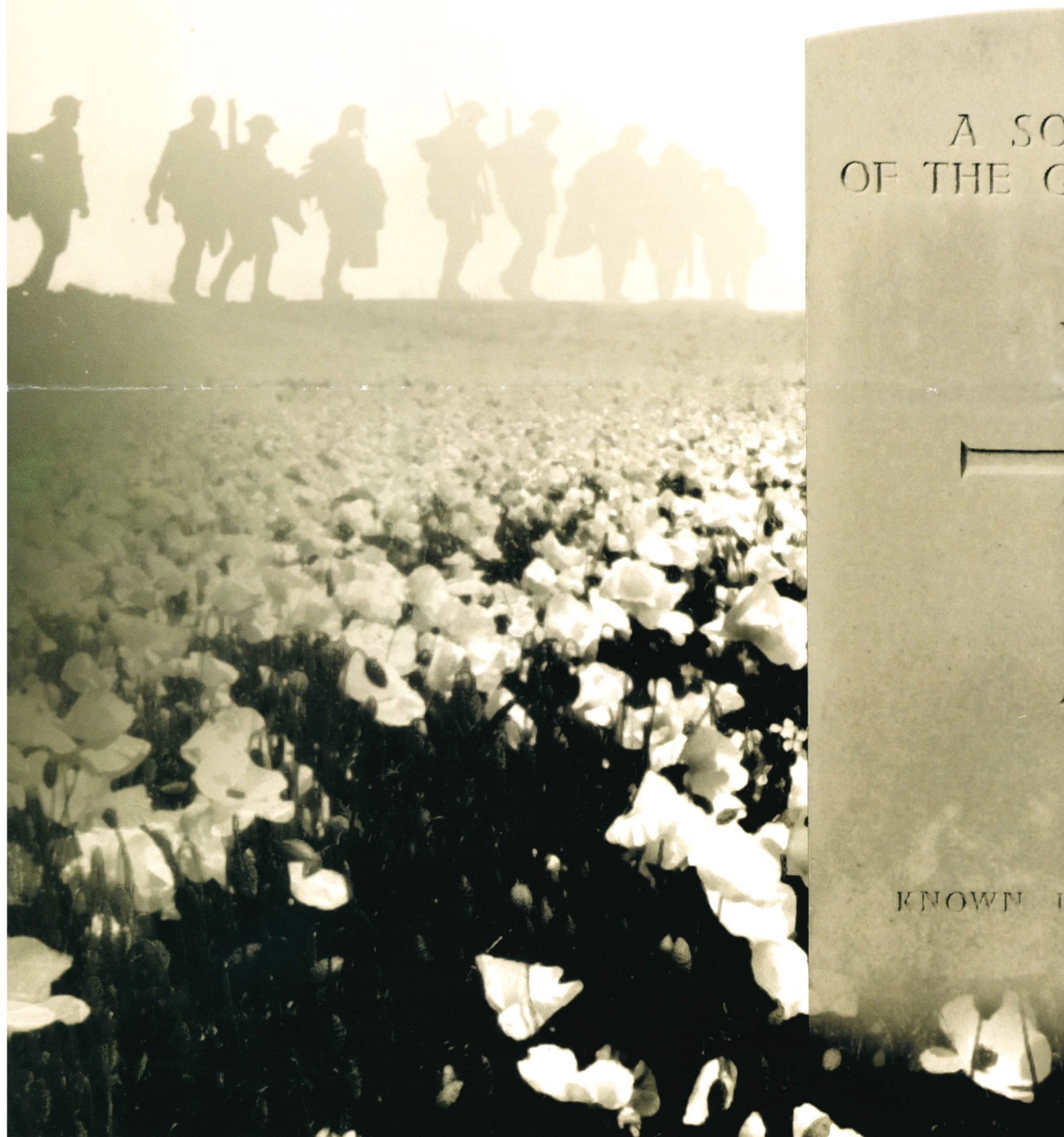
REID L. T. S.
BUTLER B. G.
JOINER C.
WIGG H. J.
TIGAR H. W.
WILLIAMSON W. R.
STEARNS E. G.
ELLIS R. L. S.
LION T. E.
WOOD A. J.
PATERSON J.
GARWOOD J. F.
ASHER K. J. P.

1 Nov. 1914
3 Feb. 1915
24 Apr. 1915
27 Apr. 1915
9 May 1915
25 May 1915
6 Aug. 1915
20 Sept. 1915
28 Sept. 1915
16 Oct. 1915
21 Oct. 1915
4 Mar. 1916
1 July 1916

PATERSON A. F.
FRYER E. H.
NAYLOR R.
ABBATI W. R.
PARSONS L. B.
SLADE F.
MASON F. G. E.
CANDLIN T. A.
FILLMORE F. A.
OLIVER W.
CHATHAM G. H.
SADD R. D.
TURNBULL H. P. M.

1 July 1916
3 Aug. 1916
5 Aug. 1916
7 Aug. 1916
12 Aug. 1916
9 Sept. 1916
2 Oct. 1916
5 Oct. 1916
13 Nov. 1916
18 Nov. 1916
23 Nov. 1916
14 Feb. 1917
29 Mar. 1917

SMITH J. G. B.
PARKSHOUSE F. M.
DENSHAM W. D.
WISEMAN H. C.
WILLIAMS J. P.
KILBURN E. N.
BATES A. J. E.
BEATTY A. H. W.
BROWN C. J. W.
JORDAN H. S. L.
HEYWOOD H.
HOOK P. L.
TIGAR G. H.



15 Apr. 1917
23 Apr. 1917
23 Apr. 1917
19 May 1917
2 June 1917
18 July 1917
30 July 1917
31 July 1917
31 July 1917
20 Aug. 1917
22 Aug. 1917
26 Sept. 1917
13 Oct. 1917

ASHFORD R. E. C.
NORRIS R. A.
MUDDOCK J. M. P.
BRADBERRY R. W.
KING F. B.
PARKER A. W.
HOOK H. C.
HAMILTON E. J.
GREEN E. de W.
CRAM H. A.
BOREHAM H. P.
TAYLOR J.
BEST J.

30 Oct. 1917
3 Nov. 1917
30 Nov. 1917
3 Dec. 1917
8 Dec. 1917
14 Mar. 1918
8 Apr. 1918
14 Apr. 1918
15 Apr. 1918
16 Apr. 1918
16 Apr. 1918
17 Apr. 1918
15 May 1918

PRINCE G. C. M.
BERRY H. H.
STILLMAN J. H.
HIGGINS A.
MUDDOCK H.
WOODBIDGE S. G.

CLOWES W. H.
GREEN T. H.
HOLDAM R. E.

24 Aug. 1918
27 Sept. 1918
30 Sept. 1918
25 Oct. 1918
24 Nov. 1918
14 Dec. 1918

LDIER
REAT WAR

NTO GOD

LEST
WE
FORGET



Boreham, H P

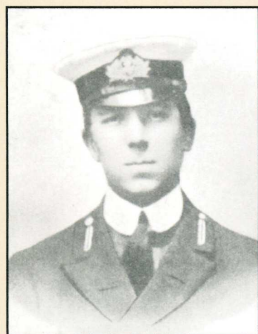
Harry Pendry Boreham was a lieutenant of the 18th Bn., Middlesex Regiment Queen Victoria Rifles who died on 16th April 1918 aged 28 in Meteren. Son of Harry White Boreham and Emma Boreham, of "Coverdale," Lower Park Rd., Hastings.

Bradberry, R W

Russel William Bradberry was a Lance Bombardier of the 301st siege battalion, royal garrison artillery who was born around 1884 and died on 3rd December 1917 of his wounds aged 33. Eldest son of Russel and Mary Rebecca Bradberry, of Wealdstone, Harrow, Middlesex; husband of Elsie Bradberry, of Wealdstone.

Brown, C J W

Charles John William Brown was a private of the 6th Bn., Cameron Highlanders who died on 31 July 1917 Age 19 of Henry John and Emily Louisa Brown, of "Boscombe," 73, Pinner Road., Harrow, Middsex. Remembered with Honour at Ypres (Menin Gate) Memorial.



Butler, B G

Basil George Butler was a midshipman aboard the H.M.S. "Clan McNaughton.", Royal Naval Reserve who died on 3rd February 1915 Age 21 Son of George Harry and Emily Agnes Butler, of "Ravens Court," Wealdstone, Harrow. Remembered with Honour at Chatham Naval Memorial. His brother Peter Butler also died with him. He died aboard

HMS Clan McNaughton.

Candlin, T A

Thomas Albert Candlin was private of 426, Machine Gun Section, Royal Buckinghamshire Hussars who died on 5th October 1916 Age 26 Son of Thomas and Maud Adeline Candlin, of The Cranny, Offord Cluny, Huntingdon. Born at Harlesden. Remembered with Honour at Pinner (Paines Lane) Cemetery. Son of Mr Thomas Candlin of Pinner View. 7 years at the Royal Bucks Hussars and was connected with London and N. W. Railway Company's Mineral Manager's Department. He was called up to Egypt in March 1915, where he underwent an operation for mastoid. He was invalided home and in spite of continued surgical treatment succumbed to the disease in Tidworth Military Hospital in November 1916. Full military honours were accorded to him at Tidworth where comrades in the Hussars and the band of the 9th Lancers with firing party and gun carriage conducted the body to the station. His funeral was at St George's Church. He was an athlete, following football and swimming with ardent interest.

Chatham, G H

George Henry Chatham, son of James and Jane Chatham, was a pupil in the John Lyon from 1897 to 1904. 10th Bn., Royal Fusiliers who died on 23rd November 1916 Age 29.

Son of the late James Henry and Jane Rebecca Chatham. Remembered with Honour at Thiépval Memorial.

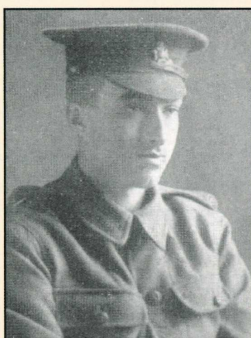
Cram, H A

Hubert Arthur Cram was a second lieutenant of the 16th battalion, king's Royal rifle Corps who died on 16th April 1918 aged 27. He was the son Son of Joseph Oliver Cram and Margaret Cram, of 56, Hindes Road, Harrow, Middlesex. Native of Eastcote, Pinner, Middlesex. He is remembered at Klein-Vierstraat British Cemetery.

Densham, William David

William David Densham was a private of the 1st/7th battalion, Gordon highlanders who died on 23rd April 1917 aged 22. He was the son of William and Jessie Margaret

Densham, of Mount View, Bickington, Barnstaple. He is remembered at Arras Memorial. Played the Duke in King Lear.



Ellis, R L S

Raynal Lucas Sordes Ellis was a private in the 5th battalion Wiltshire regiment who died on 20th September 1915 aged 19 at Gallipoli. He was the Son of Charles Sordes Ellis and Evelyn Ann Ellis, of 308, King St., Hammersmith, London. An Old Lyonian. He is remembered at East Mudros Military Cemetery.



Fillmore, F A

Frederick Arthur Fillmore was the son of Arthur and Annie Fillmore and lived on Shepcote Road in Harrow from the day he was born in 1894 until he joined the 1st battalion of the Honourable Artillery Company as a private and died on 13th November 1916 at the Battle of Ypres at the age of 22. The service was at the Baptist Chapel.

Especially gifted at essay writing in his last year at John Lyon.



Fryer, E H

Lieutenant Eric Hamilton Fryer, part of the Lancaster Fusiliers regiment, was killed in action in France on 3rd April 1916. He was instantly killed by a German sniper from the opposing 127th Wurttemberg regiment.

A fellow officer of Fryer, Captain Best Dunkley, describes him as a 'brother' and how his loss

created a 'gloom over us all.'

Garwood, J F

J F Garwood was a private in the 1st battalion, Middlesex regiment who died on 4th March 1916 and is remembered with honoured Cambrin Churchyard extension.

Green, E de W

Eric De Wilde Green was a Second Lieutenant and was in the 1st battalion of The Queen's Royal West Surrey Regiment. He died on 15th April 1918, at the age of 19. He was the son of Charles Henry De Wilde Green and Isabel Clara Green, and they lived at 58 Station Road, Harrow.

Hamilton, E J

Lieutenant E J Hamilton died on 14th April 1918 however we do not know where. It would appear that he was a "real good fellow" but had lost touch with many of his former school mates.

Heywood, H

Herbert Heywood was lieutenant in the 8th battalion, Middlesex Regiment who died on 22th August 1917 and is remembered at Dozinghem Military Cemetery. It is likely he died during the Battle of Passchendale.

Higgins, A A

Arthur A Higgins was a captain of the Army Veterinary Corps who died of bronchial pneumonia on 25th October 1918 aged 32. The Lyonian said that "one can hardly realise that a man of such splendid physique would go under." Where he had been fighting in Bulgaria peace had already been declared and "one would have hoped his life would have been spared." He had served for two years fighting in the Balkans. He was the son of Mildred Akin Higgins, of Harrow, Middlesex. He is remembered at Doiran Military Cemetery, Serbia.

Hook, C H

Rifleman Claude H. Hook died from wounds at the General Hospital in Rouen and "so by the final sacrifice, brought to a melancholy, though glorious, end three and a half years' service in France." His commanding officer wrote that "he was always cheerful, willing and a good soldier... It is one more gap in our ranks that will be hard to fill."

Claude was at the school in 1902 when he was the youngest member of the 2nd XI football team and had "extraordinary prowess as a forward." On leaving the school he went to work at the Board of Trade before volunteering to serve in the armed forces. His former chief wrote about the "high esteem (Claude) was held both as a soldier and a civil servant." His brother was P. L. Hook who at the time had been missing since late 1917.

Joiner, C

C. Joiner was killed at the Battle of Ypres, 24th April 1915. The Lyonian recorded: "C. Joiner, of the Queen Victoria Rifles, has lost his life in the grievous struggle that seems to go on endlessly in Flanders. He was at school one of the brightest of boys; and before he left obtained a position in the Civil Service. To his people we offer on behalf of his Old School our sincerest sympathy."

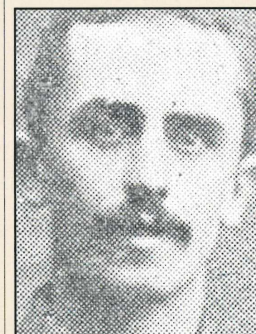


Lion, T E

Thomas Lion died in action on 29th September in Bethune (NE France), aged 20. He was hit by a shell in the trenches.

Muddock, J

He died somewhere in France, unknown around December 1917. Before that, he was engaged in business in Burma.



Naylor, R

The Harrow Gazette, speaking in 1916 said "Pte. Roland Naylor, of St. Hilda's Nurseries, South Harrow, has died from wounds received in Egypt. He was wounded in the battle at Romani on 4th August and died on 5th August 1916 and, not September 5th as mentioned in the Harrow Gazette, of his wounds. Roland was a pupil at The John Lyon School in the

years 1895-7, many years ago now, but we remember him as a good scholar and one of the quietest boys we have ever had in the school. Our sincere sympathy is with his family."

Oliver, W

Pte. W Oliver, London Irish Rifles, died at the age of 32. He was an inveterate sketcher, ambidextrous too.

**Parker, A W**

Arthur Parker was killed in action on March 14th, aged 38.

**Taylor, J H**

Joe Taylor served with the Royal Navy Air Service and was killed during an accident while on a test flight. His commanding officer reported that, "he was leaving the ground for a practice flight in a modern type of two seater, when his engine failed, and in trying to avoid some hills in front of him, he side-slipped into the ground and was killed at once." He went

on to say that Joe "had been under my command for about two years and I had a very high opinion of him." Before his death Joe had taken part in several bombing and reconnaissance flights over the Gallipoli Peninsula. He is buried in Greece at the Mudros Cemetery.

The Lyonian reported his death with a sense of "deep and unfeigned grief" and described him as "a more modest, more worthy, more respected Lyonian never came to us and the sad fatality has cut short a life full of promise." Prior to his death he was working as an engineer on the Great Western Railway and often came back to visit the School.

Tigar, G H

Died at Neuve-Chappelle, 13th October 1917 aged 21, only ten days after arrival.

**Tigar, H W**

Harold Walter Tigar was born around 1893 to parents Walter and Mary Agnes Tigar who lived at 112 Nibthwaite Road in Harrow. He had a brother called Geoffrey Herbert Tigar who was also killed in action. Harold joined the 3rd battalion of the Middlesex Regiment and was awarded the 1914-1915 campaign star medal before his death at the age of 22 on 9th May

1915 in Ypres.

Harold Tigar has passed his intermediate examination of the incorporated society of accountant.

Turnbull, P H M

Percy Hugh Maclean Turnbull entered the navy around 1912 and was on H.M.S. Britannia. He volunteered for some hazardous work and drowned on 29th March 1917. A few days prior to that, his ship had been in action with a large German submarine which was sunk. Percy had a direct part in its sinking.

Wigg, H

Herbert Wigg was part of the Australian Contingent, one of the first to die in Dardanelles, Gallipoli. He was injured in the battle but died of wounds later on his way back. He was from Australia and died on 27th April 1915.

**Williamson, W**

William Williamson was in the Royal Naval Volunteer reserve and was killed in action at the Dardanelles.

Wood, A J

A J Wood died on one of the battle fronts in Alexandria. He died of dysentery.

**Parkhouse, F**

Lieut. Frank Parkhouse (1st Battalion, Middlesex Regiment) died in action on April 23rd 1917. He joined and left the School in 1891 and 1903 (as appropriate). He was very popular, especially with a teacher named Mr J. E. Williams who thought much of him before he left. He was captain of the School. He was a good athlete

in football and cricket in particular. He had a brother called Stanley. After his school days he entered the North British and Mercantile Insurance Company and was in the Foreign Department. He entered the army as a private in the 21st battalion, soon after the outbreak of the war.

**Patterson, J C**

James Paterson was the son of James and Hannah Paterson. He was one of the most popular boys at school and was a very sound all-rounder being described as 'good at everything he took up'. He is credited as an excellent 'footballer and cricketer and a fine actor' and as a very intelligent boy. However he did not finish his education at John Lyon. He worked in

the London County and Westminster Bank for a while until he joined a machine gun regiment. He died of his wounds at Münster, Westphalia after he and twenty five other British soldiers were captured.

**Stearns, E G**

Eric Gordon Stearns was the son of Thomas Robert Stearns and was born on 25th May 1895. He joined the London Regiment.

Died from a wound; received while in charge of a digging part, digging a new trench. He was shot in the side and was killed from peritonitis.

He was a cheerful and fearless man, and was

praised by all his comrades.

He was out digging at the front line during the night, a lot of bullets were being shot by the enemy and unfortunately one bullet hit him in the side and was immediately carried out by a motor ambulance to Aberle casualty station where the following night he died.



VOICES FROM THE FRONT

By October 1915 200 Old Lyonians had volunteered to serve in the armed forces, four had been confirmed as killed in action and one was reported as missing in action, according to the Lyonian published in October 1915. In fact by the end of October 1915, 11 Old Lyonians had made the supreme sacrifice. Throughout the war the School received an extraordinary amount of correspondence from its former pupils on the front line. The level of detail provides a great insight into their life at the front. Below are a few extracts from some of the letters:

EXTRACTS FROM A LETTER

by E H Fryer, written 1st September 1915

"The dugouts are simple luxurious, and in every one there is a bed composed of wire netting stretched on a wooden frame and covered with straw. They are really quite comfortable, but the opportunities for undisturbed sleep are very few."

"Opposite us the Huns are, on average 300 yards away. They are fairly quiet during the day, with the exception of their artillery, which generally gives us three or four doses everyday. It doesn't take so very long to get used to a bombardment, but even then it is no light matter and is rather apt to try the nerves... the Huns do very little real damage."

"Pretty regularly every evening the enemy's machine guns treat us to a chorus. Their gunners are very clever, and they sweep along the top of our parapets in fine style in hopes of catching a sentries head sticking up on the lookout."

"Their rifle shooting, with a few exceptions, is not at all good opposite us. We do a certain amount of sniping, but their loopholes are very cunningly concealed, and they so very seldom show their head above the ground that it requires a very skilled shot to do any serious damage."

"In the trenches we are rather troubled by a shortage of water and excess of flies and all manner of bugs and insects. We get enough water to drink, but we have to use water out of holes made by shells for washing and it is very green. The Battalion was in the trenches for a fortnight last time so it becomes quite necessary to wash occasionally during such a long spell."

EXTRACTS FROM "THE TALE OF THE SOMME"

published in the Lyonian Magazine 1917

"In this trench were many dead or wounded Germans. Some of them had ghastly wounds. Some had their faces crushed right in, just as one might knock in the side of a hollow chocolate egg. Others had limbs blown clean off."

POEM

In memoriam of Raynal Ellis 1915

If tasks be set for every generation,
Maybe none greater and none nobler than
The task to shield the honour of this nation
Could claim the better qualities of man;
And courage, strengths and talents so enlisted
Supporting mighty principles of truth
All glorify the cause they have assisted
And speak the aims of well-instructed youth.

Thus forth he went in manhood's early morning
His task to do – his country's name to save:
For self he recked not, and all danger scorning
Sought a soldier's glory or a grave...
Peaceful he lies with patriot comrades sleeping
The task performed that victory might be won
If Britain's cause be served and its upkeeping
We freely yield, though miss and mourn, our son.

EXTRACTS FROM A LETTER

by F Harrington, written August 1915

Talking about enemy snipers "...the snipers, who do most deadly work. They get so much for every identity disc they obtain from the man they kill. One was found recently with 27, including a Major's. A girl sniper of 17 was also captured; face, hands, rifle – in fact everything, painted green."

EXTRACTS FROM A LETTER

by E Chatham, published in November 1915 in the Lyonian Magazine

"Suddenly at 5 a.m. it seemed as if Hell had broken loose. A thousand guns began to speak. The great shells shrieked over our heads and dashed themselves against the German trenches. The ground rocked as with an earthquake. The German guns too, were not idle, and our own parapets began to suffer. The strain in the nerves was terrific. Many fellows lost their reason during the awful 50 minutes that the bombardment lasted. Finally, at 5:50am was reached, the guns ceased as suddenly as they had begun. Our Captain gave the word to advance, clearing the parapet as he did so, and we followed rapidly after. Almost immediately a terrific fire of rifles, machine guns, and shrapnel was opened on us and men fell in scores. We had 350 yards of open country to charge across, and the ground was uneven and full of wide ditches and shell holes. As we ran men fell faster."

Chatham was hit in the leg but carried on the fight for several hours taking refuge in various trenches as he followed orders to advance and retreat. While taking shelter in one captured trench and having held off several German attacks, with his battalion, he wrote:

"After about four hours we had to suffer a 40 minute bombardment by our own shells. We had an artillery flag on the trench, but our gunners, not knowing of our existence, evidently took it for a German ruse. Several fellows were hit, and once I was almost buried with earth... eventually our gunners understood, after the constant waving of our flag, and from now onwards gave us immense assistance. Every time the enemy attacked, a shower of shrapnel and high explosives checked them; otherwise I don't think we could have possibly have held out."

He then recounts how under the cover of darkness and because he was wounded he was ordered back to the lines, "Heavy firing prevented my starting till about 2 am, but with two wounded chums, I at last got going, and after a painful journey, crawling over thousands of dead and dying, and under heavy rifle fire, I reached our lines safely, where I found hundreds of wounded, who, like myself, had crawled in from the open."

LYONIAN DAILY

IN MEMORY

28TH JULY 1914 - 11TH NOVEMBER 1918

CENTENARY EDITION

4TH AUGUST ~ BRITAIN JOINS THE WAR

THE 59 LYONIANS



Eric Stearns

An introduction from Mr C. Longhurst & Mr J. Moore

The 59 Club is The John Lyon School's latest History society for boys in Years 9 and 10, but also some gifted Year 8 students. It was established in November 2013 in response to the forthcoming First World War centenary commemorations: 59 being the number of John Lyon pupils who fought and died in the conflict between 1914 and 1918. Subsequent research has shown this number to actually be 61 (60 pupils and 1 teacher), but we have decided to keep the original name.

Members of *The 59 Club* have been very busy on Friday lunch times using the computers to research the lives and deaths of these men and as a mark of respect, have created this impressive piece of work. The History Department would like to take this opportunity to thank the boys for their hard work over the last year and commitment to this considerable task and for creating such a fantastic commemorative overview of these men's lives - 'The 59 Club: The Fallen'.

This piece of work contains information about 44 of the 61 men. The level of detail varies considerably due to the amount of information that is available from a whole host of websites that the boys have explored, as well as letters from the trenches that have been read carefully. Within this piece of work there are some truly compelling and moving stories of loss and sacrifice. Unfortunately, for three of the Lyonians, all that could be found was a date of death, highlighting the chaotic nature of the First World War and the records kept.

In future years, *The 59 Club* will commemorate the anniversary of an event of the pupils' choosing. The Year 11 boys will graduate to *The 59 Upper Club* where historical themes will be discussed with Sixth Form pupils and History teachers.

Next year's commemorative event will be the 70th anniversary of the conclusion of the Second World War. *The 59 Club* will be researching the lives of the Old Lyonians that fell in that conflict. Coincidentally, and rather eerily, 60 Old Lyonians and 1 member of staff died in that conflict as well, according to current records. Will the new *59 Club* detect additional pupils or teachers who gave their lives?

THE FIRST & LAST

THE FIRST

Reid, L T S

It is believed that L T S Reid died on the penultimate day of the Battle of Messines from 12th October to 2nd November 1914. He was a school captain and a former editor of the *Lyonian Magazine*. He was the first Lyonian to fall. He scored 100 for the school cricket team in 1913 and was awarded a pewter tankard for it. Despite this he was not viewed as an amazing batsman and was criticised because of this. He was in the London Scottish and was aged just 17 when he fell.

THE LAST

Woodbridge, S

Captain Stanley Woodbridge, Military Cross, was the last Lyonian to perish as a result of World War One. His death is recorded as 18th December 1918, although he was severely wounded earlier in the year. The way he died perhaps reflects the horrific nature of the conflict. He is first reported as injured by the Lyonian late in 1918. It states: "We are very grieved to hear that Captain Stanley Woodbridge M.C. was so terribly wounded. After lying for six hours on the battle field, bleeding well nigh to death, he was taken back to the hospital, where amputation of the leg was imperative. He is still too exhausted to write or receive visitors; but he was able to dictate a letter, for which we were grateful" (sadly the letter appears lost). He was one of 10 Lyonians to be awarded the Military Cross for his bravery on the front line, and the only one of those ten who made the ultimate sacrifice.

A later edition then reported that he had "died from his wounds" due to the fact that his "leg was shattered by a shell, and he lay on the field bleeding to death. Although brought home to England, he was too weak to recover." It went on to describe him as a "splendid young fellow, and before the war he led the Old Lyonian Football Teams to a long series of victories." The *Lyonian* has frequent mention of him as a talented sportsman and strong participant with the Old Boys teams.

He is buried and remembered at Harrow St Mary's Lower Churchyard.

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